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Mayor's new HR chief faced earlier complaints

Staffer alleged Hinton made 'political threats' after finding mistake

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson's new human resources chief was accused during her time in the city's procurement department of threatening staffers and interfering with attempts to correct employees who fell short of the city's contracting protocols.

Tiheta Hinton, confirmed last month as Johnson's commissioner of the Department of Human Resources, faced harassment complaints when she was second in command at the Department of Procurement Services, according to personnel files released to the Tribune in a public records request this week.

In one report a staffer alleged Hinton made "political threats" after discovering a mistake in the bidding process for a contract at the airports.

"(Hinton) stated, 'you don't know who I am', 'you don't know who I know'. She then proceeds to say, 'I'm going down to the Fifth Floor' repeatedly," the April 2024 complaint says. "It's awfully disturbing to work in fear that if another mistake or error occurs that I will surmise the threat of being fired by 'Fifth Floor' because of (Hinton's) political connections."

The Department of Human Resources declined to investigate those allegations, saying they fell outside its purview. Another memo from the department says Hinton was subsequently scheduled to attend a "meeting for performance termination" in 2025.

In statements on Thursday to the Tribune, Hinton and Johnson press secretary Allison Novelo denied all allegations of Hinton violating HR or procurement policy but did not answer questions about why that

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The former Michael Reese Hospital sits on Thursday in the nearly 50-acre plot that, along with the Prairie Shores apartments, at left, and the McCormick Place Marshaling Yard, to the right, make up a proposed stadium site for the Chicago Bears. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/TRIBUNE**

New vision unveiled for ex-Michael Reese site

Proposed megadevelopment includes housing, retail and a possible Bears stadium

By Brian J. Rogal and Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The team attempting to build Bronzeville Lakefront, a proposed megadevelopment on the former location of Michael Reese Hospital, unveiled a new vision Thursday for the site, including housing, retail, hotels and a possible domed stadium for the Chicago Bears.

It's the third group of developers in as many weeks to announce a plan to bring the team to the South Side. The scramble to work up Chicago stadium proposals comes ahead of next week's fall veto session in Springfield, where state legislators will meet and likely vote on several proposals designed to keep the Bears in Illinois.

The South Side proposals have so far drawn cool responses from the Bears, who seem intent on moving from Soldier Field to either suburban Arlington Heights or Hammond, Indiana. The team did not immediately comment Thursday on the latest stadium proposal involving the Michael Reese site.

GRIT Chicago, the consortium of developers and investors leading the Michael Reese project, said their vision answers criticisms leveled by the Bears that several proposed South Side locations are too narrow for a football stadium or would encroach on existing housing or rail yards.

The consortium proposes to combine their 48-acre Michael Reese plot with Golub & Co.'s Prairie Shores high-rise apartment community to the west and the McCormick Place Marshaling Yard to the east, more than doubling the site to 100 acres.

"More than once, what we've heard from the Bears is that the stadium would not fit on the Michael Reese site," said Quintin Primo, executive chairman of Capri Investment Group and newest member of GRIT Chicago. But with this expansion, "there is

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Biologist Chelsea Rochman, from left, Jessie Wilson and Francis Nuamah collect samples of microplastics along the shoreline on Oct. 2, 2025, at the Experimental Lakes Area, a research station in western Ontario. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'Actions can have a distant impact'

Study: Plastic waste in Great Lakes could be coming from as far as 120 miles away

By Michael Hawthorne
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For scientists working to keep plastic litter out of the environment, the idea might seem counterintuitive.

Looking to follow the movement of water bottles and other floating throwaways, they tossed dozens of plastic smoothie shakers into rivers across the United States and Canada, including stretches of the Chicago River.

The researchers equipped each of the shakers with a small GPS device to track where they ended up.

Computer modeling of the results suggests half of the plastic bottles washing into the Great Lakes and oceans every year come from at least 10 miles and up to 120 miles away, the scientists reported.

In other words, far away from shoreline trash traps and volunteer beach cleanups that tend to be the focus of efforts to combat plastic pollution.

The study shows cities and towns upstream also have a role to play. "It shows a community's actions can have a distant impact, even in places like the Midwest where we often consider ourselves landlocked," said Tim Hoellein, a Loyola University biologist and

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Nvidia co-founder, CEO resigns amid scandals

Stunningly swift fall for one of tech's most powerful innovators

By Kelvin Chan and Matt Sedensky
ASSOCIATED PRESS



Huang

Nvidia co-founder Jensen Huang resigned as its CEO on Thursday, capping a spectacular downfall for a booster of the artificial intelligence boom whose exit following reports of extramarital affairs now propels the chipmaker into an uncertain future.

After a dizzying series of headlines about Huang's infidelity and ties to an alleged Chinese spy, his departure sets off a scramble to find a permanent replacement to lead the multitrillion-dollar colossus that grew from obscurity to a perch between Apple and Microsoft at the top of the S&P index.

The resignation sent shares of Nvidia plummeting 14% at the opening bell, before stabilizing. The stock closed down about 4% Thursday as investors pondered the lawsuits, investigations, likely corporate jockeying and the resilience of a market driven by the gains of a few tech giants.

"Huang's departure introduces uncertainty well beyond the company itself," said Asa Hiken, senior analyst for research firm eMarketer, reflecting fears of wider implications and the possibility of an AI bubble.

Nvidia has named Colette Kress, the executive vice president and chief financial officer, as interim chief executive. She became CFO in 2013, overseeing the company's global finance

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SPECIAL SECTION

Chicago area's top workplaces



Artificial intelligence is everywhere. It's on our phones, our web browsers and increasingly embedded in the workplace. Our annual Top Workplaces report spotlights the rise of AI and how local companies are using it.

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